



Turkey



Tasty pastry

Among the sweetest treats in Central Asia is baklava, a popular honey and nut pastry dessert.

Suleiman the Magnificent

Turkey was the heartland of the Ottoman Empire.

During the reign of sultan Suleiman I (1520–1566), the empire expanded all the way into Europe, northern Africa, and western Asia.



Majestic Mosque

The spectacular 17th-century Sultan Ahmed Mosque dominates the Istanbul skyline. Also known as the Blue Mosque, it has patterned blue tiles on its inside walls.



One of six towering minarets from which worshippers are called to prayer.

Patara beach

One of Turkey's beauty spots is the 11-mile (18 km) long Patara Beach, south of Mugla. It lies close to the ruins of an ancient city.



Turkey stretches from **eastern Europe** to **western Asia**. Straddling both continents, this country has a mix of **Islamic** and **Western traditions**. Turkey's largest city, **Istanbul**, was once the **center of the Byzantine Empire**, before the region was taken over by the **Ottomans**, who ruled Turkey for **more than 600 years**.



- 📏 302,535 sq miles (783,562 sq km)
- 👤 82 million
- ★ Ankara
- 🗣️ Turkish, other languages (+7)